

Speaker 1 [00:00:08] Is the audio okay? I think it's recording now.

Speaker 2 [00:00:13] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:15] Well, I'll start with some basic questions to get to know more about you. For basic information, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [20-25].

Speaker 1 [20-25] years old? How long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker 2 [<1 year].

Speaker 1 [<1 year]? Do you have any children?

Speaker 2 No.

Speaker 1 Who do you live with?

Speaker 2 [00:00:55] I live with my younger brother. We live here in [Country]; I spend the week with him, and then on the weekends, I go to my parents' house. So, I spend the weekends with everyone together. But during the week, most of the time, it's just me and my brother. Do you understand? So, it's a transition.

Speaker 1 [00:01:17] What is your main source of income, and what is your current profession?

Speaker 2 [00:01:45] Still from my parents, and I don't work; I only [occupation]. So, I'm a [occupation]

Speaker 1 That's important. Before we start, how would you like me to refer to your partner? Partner, girlfriend, companion, wife?

Speaker 2 Girlfriend.

Speaker 1 [00:01:47] Okay. Let's start with the relationship itself. Can you tell me more or less your love story with her? How did you meet?

Speaker 2 [00:01:52] I'll try to illuminate it. It started very crazy, like we both joined [degree program] right? So we met in the [1st-5th] semester in the same class, but she entered through [Name], and I entered through the entrance exam. We made separate friends, and then suddenly, we joined a large group of friends, you know? So, we came from the same group of friends. This group of friends is still together today, and I'm in the fourth semester, so everything is going well. If I were to tell you everything, it would be a lot, you know? But anyway, it started. Before her, I hadn't been with any woman. But then it was something that developed between me and her in our group of friends, you know? In our daily lives, having lunch together. We always talked, because everyone here talked about so and so, you know, these things. And then suddenly, something started to develop between me and her, like a sexual tension, you know? And then there came a moment when I wanted to be with her, she wanted to talk to me, and we both knew it. But then, it took a while, and we built it up for about a month before we finally got together, you know? And then we started seeing each other with friends, going to parties. And then, it was seeing each other every day, every class, everything together. And then I started to develop feelings for her. I talked to her about it, and at that time, she kind of rejected me, saying it was too complicated. Then I spent some time trying to get over her, and then after

the year-end holidays, she kind of regretted it, you know? Realized that I was missing. So she came to talk to me, and we started getting together again. Then we started dating, and that's basically it in a nutshell.

Speaker 1 But there's an important detail. You said that if you talked more, it would be a lot. Actually, the more you can talk, the better for us. So if you want to go into more detail, it's better.

Speaker 2 I like to hear stories with more details, so narrating with details is good.

Speaker 1 Another question is how would you compare the quality of your relationship to that of your friends?

Speaker 2 Compared to my friends?

Speaker 1 Yes, compared to your friends' relationships, not your relationships with your friends. What do you see?

Speaker 2 I think it's a quality thing, at least I see that my friends have healthy relationships, so in that regard, I don't see much difference. But in terms of quality, it's different because they are straight. There's the whole issue of coming out that I don't have, so in that regard, I understand it in better words, but that's it.

Speaker 1 I understand. You used the word healthy. Why do you think a relationship would be healthier in comparison?

Speaker 2 I don't know, but mine is too. Do you understand?

Speaker 1 I understand.

Speaker 2 In terms of quality, of being a good relationship, I see it as equal, you know? I can't think of any bad relationships among my friends at the moment. So, in that regard, it's equal. Do you understand? There's no difference in quality.

Speaker 1 [00:07:37] So yes, yes, I understand. And do you mind telling me how many romantic partners you have had?

Speaker 2 [00:07:42] No, no. Like, I never had anything serious with anyone before her. I might have been with several people, but I never had something with someone before her, you understand?

Speaker 1 [00:07:48] And in relation to your current relationship, how do you compare its quality to these previous cases? Since you say they were like...

Speaker 2 [00:08:22] Much, much better.

Speaker 1 [00:08:25] Ah, and why would you say it's better, perhaps?

Speaker 2 [00:08:27] I think it's hard to compare because I never dated anyone before her, so I never had such a strong bond with someone for a long time. And right now, everything is going very well. My relationship with her is working out great. Except for the delicate part about family and coming out. Aside from that little detail, we don't fight or anything, and everything is going very well. So, everything is very good for me. Honestly.

Speaker 1 [00:09:18] And what would you say is good about your relationship? How can I put this? How would you say your relationship is good? In what aspects would you consider it good?

Speaker 2 [00:09:36] Maybe because I'm young and experiencing this for the first time. Like, when I stopped to think about what we were experiencing and everything. I had never experienced really sharing your life with someone and everything. Everything I do, I want her to be present. Or when she's not, I want to tell her everything. I want to know everything about her life. So, it's very crazy to really want someone to be present in every aspect of your life and really share your life. Before, I was alone, and now I have her, so she's in all aspects of my life at the moment, you know? Do you understand how this permeates everything in this type of relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:10:27] Well, I understand. Another question, for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:10:34] It's a bit complex to know. I need to share, because this insight makes me reflect a lot on this, to share your life with someone, and it's like, depending on the day and the way, that's why the coexistence also matters a lot. It's good to see people in all forms, like stressed, annoyed, in good or bad moods. So this coexistence, I don't know how to define it. Convincing and truly sharing your life, you know? I don't know if I managed to answer, but that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:11:30] And how important is love to you?

Speaker 2 [00:11:31] For me? Well, I think it's the foundation of everything.

Speaker 1 And how do you know your girlfriend loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:12:07] I think it's through what she tells me. What's the word? When I reciprocate what I have, like. It's in the daily routine, like the small things, details. We notice that they are simple things. I brought this for you, I thought of you. So, the weight of these small daily acts, you know?

Speaker 1 And what is most important to you in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:13:35] I think partnership itself.

Speaker 1 [00:13:36] The next question is about conflicts in general. What are the challenges you face in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:13:38] The biggest of all is the issue with my parents, mainly because, in our relationship, we are always very different in this regard, you know? Like, her family has known from the beginning, and my family doesn't know, and I have no perspective on when they will find out. Do you understand? So, that's the biggest conflict in our relationship.

Speaker 1 And how often would you say this kind of difficulty appears in your daily life? More or less.

Speaker 2 Always, because after I go to my parents' house, you know? Like, there are days when we are not together, and I'm there, and every day there's some detail, every day, every day, because I have to go because there's this, because it's family, involving my family in a call, and I tell them that I'm with someone else. So, it's there every day.

Speaker 1 Ah, and how would you say you resolve this difficulty?

Speaker 2 [00:14:56] We don't try to resolve it. It just disappears. We talk a lot about it from the beginning because even before we had a relationship, it was a topic for us not to have a relationship. So it was a lot about her accepting and living this, going through this with me. So it's about waiting. So, the question was how I faced this?

Speaker 1 How do you resolve this divergence?

Speaker 2 [00:15:43] We try to resolve it in the daily routine. And on her part, it's about waiting, you know? Like, my time is everything, and I always told her that this is a certainty in my life that I will tell. So we kind of have this agreement. But this certainty that I will tell is that she will wait for my time, you know?

Speaker 1 And besides that, her understanding that there is this time and you assuring her that it will happen, would you say there are other ways you use to maintain the relationship besides strategies like these? What would they be if there are any strategies for this conflict and to maintain the relationship, let's say?

Speaker 2 [00:16:28] Overall, I think it's more about this security that I provide for her. You know, it's really what I want. And even though it's something very difficult for me to deal with my parents, I have this certainty that it will happen because I won't let it interfere only with me. I think that's the security I give her.

Speaker 1 I understand. And would you also say that your relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2 Yes, because it makes me feel good. And I have never been as happy as I am at this moment, you know? So, overall, it makes me feel very good. In both good and bad moments.

Speaker 1 [00:17:28] Do you believe that your relationship has changed anything in you? And if so, in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:17:31] Oh, definitely. I have been very happy since the beginning, but because of my sexuality and everything, I never stayed with a woman before, so that has already changed. And I think it changes, yes. It changes us. But I don't know how to explain it. I think we learn from coexistence that I mentioned, you can always learn to live with people. And then, I don't know how to put it into words. But it has changed me a lot, I think.

Speaker 1 [00:18:35] Do you think this change was for you as a person, as a whole, or as a girlfriend in the relationship itself?

Speaker 2 [00:18:38] I think as a person. Mainly that and also regarding my parents, you know? Like, it gave me a very different perspective on many things.

Speaker 1 [00:18:53] Do you believe your girlfriend has also changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:18:56] Yes, yes. In the same way, as a whole, as I said about me. Let's put it this way, as a girlfriend, not just as a person, you understand? And in more specific things, I could talk more about her than about myself.

Speaker 1 [00:19:29] And could you explain why you think that about her? Maybe not being the same person as at the beginning of the relationship. What might have changed?

Speaker 2 [00:19:31] I think one of the things from the beginning that we had, her difficulty, was that in the beginning, I was the one who talked to her once, and she just said no and everything. She had trouble expressing her feelings. And now, that has changed, you know? We talk a lot, and she says it happened because of me. The fact is that before she didn't express her feelings. So, everything is a process, but now she talks about everything. Because she saw this change in herself and told me she saw it, and now she can talk about things more easily, you understand?

Speaker 1 Do you feel secure in your relationship? And if so, what makes you feel secure? Can you give me a concrete example?

Speaker 2 Yes. I think this is one of the things you asked if I changed, right? I used to be very insecure about everything, and today I feel secure, not just in the relationship. Not in the general sense. So that would be for another question. But, man, I don't know why now I feel secure, but it's crazy because I don't know.

Speaker 1 [00:21:16] An example you could give me in your daily life. I don't know, some attitude from her that makes you feel secure, maybe.

Speaker 2 It's not something specific, but I think it's everything, you know? I mean, that she agreed? We both agreed. There is this whole problem in our relationship. Like, why would she be dating if she didn't really love me so much? I feel secure with this as a whole, you know? Because of everything she does, everything she tells me, and everything we live. So, no, not even today. In these [<1 year], there hasn't been a moment when I felt insecure.

Speaker 1 [00:22:22] I understand. Okay, now there's a part where I'll show you a quick scale. I'll go to another screen, and you will indicate your answer to me. You'll understand quickly. Let me see here. No. Can you still see it?

Speaker 2 [00:22:35] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:22:37] Okay. I've adjusted it here. This first phrase, "My partner really listens to me," from one not true at all to nine completely true. How much do you agree with this statement?

Speaker 2 [00:22:57] Nine. Nine is fine.

Speaker 1 [00:23:02] The next phrase, again, from one not true at all to nine completely true. How much do you agree with this statement? "My partner cares about my needs."

Speaker 2 [00:23:14] Nine as well.

Speaker 1 [00:23:16] Nine as well. Can you explain to me why you chose nine for the first phrase?

Speaker 2 [00:23:28] I can. Based on what we have lived, you know, like we talk a lot. And I think this conversation is very much about dialogue because I prioritize this in our relationship from the beginning. To say, "Hey, tell me things, and I'll always tell you too." So we have this very good habit of really, if something happens, we talk about it right away,

not prolonging it. So, when I say something, this dialogue is very good in our relationship, so she always listens to me.

Speaker 1 [00:24:29] And can you explain why you chose nine for this phrase?

Speaker 2 [00:24:36] Because of her actions that I see, always caring about what I need, what she needs, always asking and looking for what we have in common. And I don't know, but because of her actions, you know?

Speaker 1 Now, I'm going to stop sharing the screen quickly, but soon I'll come back to it. We're going to enter a part with more questions, and it will be a category that, if you feel comfortable, you can answer, but if you don't want to, there's no problem. There are some questions about your physical intimacy in general. So, if you don't want to answer, there's no problem. It's a small part. Have you been having sexual relations lately?

Speaker 2 Yes.

Speaker 1 Are you satisfied with your sex life? And why do you think that?

Speaker 2 [00:25:51] Very satisfied. I think this because I had never experienced this before, you know? So, I'm very happy with it because I had never really experienced it before, you know? So it has never been this good.

Speaker 1 [00:26:06] I understand. That was just this part. I'll go back to the screen with the scale quickly. In general, how satisfied are you with your relationship? And you can indicate one of these options here.

Speaker 2 I think because of what I said about my family, it's between very satisfied. So, very satisfied.

Speaker 1 Okay, so let me come here. Within this very satisfied, how much would you give on the scale from 0 to 10? A scale we have from zero, being not satisfied at all, to ten, being completely satisfied, in your very satisfied. Where would you put the number on the scale?

Speaker 2 [00:27:54] Nine.

Speaker 1 [00:27:55] Nine. Okay. And again, asking why would you say it's nine? Why didn't you answer closer to ten or more to the opposite, which is zero?

Speaker 2 Yes, it's what I told you. I think if it weren't for my family, if they accepted and knew, I would be completely satisfied. I learned something important in the relationship. I participate in her family, you know? But she can't participate in mine. So, because of that, I'm not completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 I understand. So, [Participant's Name], I'm going to stop sharing here. And I'd like to ask you because we are almost done. These questions have been analyzed, and I'd like to ask if there's anything you'd like to add, something I didn't ask, an important detail about your relationship that you want to share.

Speaker 2 [00:29:09] No. I think I've said everything, I've shared everything.

Speaker 1 So, I'd like to thank you for participating. Thank you for agreeing to come here and contribute to this research. I'd like to ask one more thing. If you could suggest some couples you know, maybe LGBT couples, for me to interview to understand a bit more, as I

need contacts for interviews. You could send it to me via [Social Media]. It would really help a lot. They need to be LGBT couples, right? You don't have to interview the person I will suggest. I will ask them to recommend someone else for the interview. They need to know LGBT couples that I can interview.

Speaker 2 Okay. Can I ask why that is? Like, what is the reason behind this division? What is this about?

Speaker 1 Well, they explained to us that the intention is to be as far from the researcher as possible. So you are already someone I don't know personally. We can't interview friends or acquaintances. The intention is to be as far as possible to avoid bias in the research. They explained this to us at the beginning. It was super confusing, but now I understand that the indicated person should suggest another person. So, I'm already thanking you, and for those two options, do you want to keep your choice of anonymity and allow full transcription? Or do you prefer to transcribe less sensitive parts if you're uncomfortable? You can review during the interview, right?

Speaker 2 The full transcription without identification is fine.

Speaker 1 Okay. Thank you, [Participant's Name]. If you could send me a contact as soon as possible, I'll try to schedule the interview with them. It would be helpful.

Speaker 2 I will send it.

Speaker 1 Thank you, [Participant's Name]. Besides, you.

Speaker 2 Good luck! Thank you.